PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Intonation With Tag Questions

A tag question is when a statement is presented in the form of a question. Since the speaker tags on an extra little "tail" answering the question like "isn't it?" they are not actually asking for an answer at all. You, as the listener, will have to decide if they really want an answer or if they are answering their own question or just agreement. You will have to listen to the intonation. If the speaker raises the intonation at the end, you will know they are hoping for an answer.



My new jeans are great, aren't they? (no answer required, they want an agreement)



My baby is adorable, isn't she! (no answer required, they want an agreement)



Sarah didn't come back yet, did she? (Speaker is not sure, they want an answer)